

Introduction

Deadlines

The link to the **Slack HT26** is [here](#).

The link for HotCRP HT26 period 2, and 45 credit students is here:

<https://uu-ht26.hotcrp.com/>

The next deadline for submitting a project plan for BSc period 2, and 45 credits students is:
Mon 12 Oct 17:00.

The link to the **Slack VT27** is [here](#).

The link for HotCRP VT27 will be available soon.

The next deadline for submitting a project plan VT27 is: Fri 27 Nov 17:00.

Here is a [document](#) that gives you a preview of the application form.

Communication

There are two communication channels to contact the thesis coordinator:

General queries

Post the questions in the dedicated Slack workspace.

Follow the Slack workspace rules and remember: no DMs.

Email exjobb@it.uu.se

For urgent queries. All students are instructed to include the below information in all of their correspondence. Failure to include this information will result in delays in responding to emails.

Descriptive email subject

Personnummer

Full name

Study program

For example:

Subject: Question about Subject Reviewer

[Body of the email]

Kind regards,

101010101010

Maria Häll

MSc. Computer Science

General information about thesis projects

In general, a thesis project is a research project that is typically completed as a requirement for obtaining a graduate degree. It involves conducting original research on a particular topic and presenting a well-structured and well-supported argument or conclusion in the form of a written thesis or dissertation.

The scope of a thesis project can vary widely depending on the field of study and the requirements of the specific program. It can range from a literature review or a theoretical analysis to a full-scale empirical study. In some cases, a thesis project may also involve a creative component, such as a piece of software.

The main objective of a thesis project is to demonstrate the student's ability to conduct independent research, analyse data, and communicate their findings effectively.

According to the Higher Education Ordinance (1993:100) issued by the Swedish Council for Higher Education, a degree shall always involve a degree project, formally marking the end of the studies. The outcomes are a demonstration of the following skills: knowledge and understanding, competence and skills, and judgement and approach. Follow the links to read the expected outcome for a particular degree with specific credits.

Roles

The thesis project involves several individuals at various stages. It is important to know who is responsible for a particular task.

Thesis Coordinator

Responsible for overseeing and monitoring the entire thesis project process.

Supervisor /Handledare

Responsible for assigning a thesis project, and providing guidance and support to the students in order to help them achieve their project goals. A supervisor can be at a company or Uppsala University. Read more about the role of the supervisor in the FAQ section under (what should I answer if my supervisor asked about their expectations within the role?)

Subject Reviewer / Ämnesgranskare

Responsible for assessing whether the project meets the academic standards and expectations set by the discipline or subject area, and following the progress of the project. A subject reviewer is a lecturer, researcher, or PhD student employed at Uppsala University. You can read more about the duties and responsibilities of the subject reviewer [here](#).

Student (you)

Responsible for taking ownership of the project, working diligently to complete it, and ensuring that it meets the academic standards and requirements set by the institution or the

academic program. The student should demonstrate initiative, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills throughout the project.

Examiner

Responsible for evaluating the student's work and determining if it meets the standards and requirements set by the institution or the academic program. The Examiner's role is to assess the student's performance and provide a fair and impartial evaluation of the project. The thesis examiners for each program are:

- Image Analysis and Machine Learning: Nataša Sladoje.
- Computer Science: Lars-Henrik Eriksson, Justin Pearson (please note that Justin is the secondary examiner and should not normally be contacted directly by students)
- Computational Science: Jörn Zimmerling, Murtazo Nazarov
- Embedded Systems: Ramanathan Thinniyam Srinivasan, Bengt Jonsson.
- Data Science: Davide Vega D'Aurelio.
- Computer and Information Engineering: Anders Arweström Jansson, Filip Malmberg (last day was 30 Sep).
- Industrial Analytics: Hans Karlsson, Olle Gällmo

Student opponent

Responsible for providing an impartial and constructive evaluation of the project and the presenter's performance, highlighting both the strengths and weaknesses of the work.

Requirement for a thesis project

In addition to the requirements outlined in the course syllabus, the following requirements apply.

Masters Programme in Image Analysis and Machine Learning, 120 credits (TBA2M)

The project must be clearly connected to the area of image analysis, which nowadays typically brings in machine learning approaches. An obvious way to meet this requirement is to work with image data. If this obvious criterion is not met, the project description and, ultimately, the report itself, must convincingly explain the connection and relevance to the field of image analysis and machine learning. In general, it is not sufficient to work on a project which involves machine learning on data other than images. Exceptionally, and based on sufficiently strong arguments, such a project might be approved (however, this requires discussion with the course examiner prior to approval of the specification).

Furthermore, a successful project meets the requirements defined by the stated learning outcomes. The most important of these requirements are:

- There are clearly defined and delimited goals of the project, outlining relevant (and clearly stated) scientific and/or technical image analysis related problems to be addressed.

- The chosen method(s) are connected to the scientific literature. It is expected that the choice of the method(s) is justified based on the image analysis problem at hand and contextualised with respect to possible alternative choices.
- The presented approach is evaluated by following a proper scientific approach. It is assessed (quantified) to which extent the presented approach meets some clearly defined evaluation criteria. This may be in the form of empirical evaluation and/or theoretical validation (e.g., as mathematical proof). The evaluation method(s) should be suitable for the chosen criteria, and be motivated as such.
- The key findings of the project are analysed and discussed in depth, both positive and negative when applicable, in a manner that demonstrates understanding and knowledge of the subject matter.
- Whenever applicable, societal and ethical aspects of the problem, as well as of the solution, are discussed. Some remaining open problems are identified.
- The project is a result of an independent (supervised) work performed within the defined time-frame. It is summarised in a written report of a high linguistic quality, which follows a predefined format.
- In particular, note that pure implementation work is not considered sufficient for a degree project. A comparative analysis of several existing methods, which are selected based on a literature study, implemented, and applied to solve a certain image analysis task, and then evaluated based on a set of suitably selected criteria, is considered to be a suitable master project.

Masters Programme in Computer Science, 120 credits (TDV2M)

The project must be clearly connected to the area of Computer Science. Computer Science is a broad area and there is a substantial overlap with other areas. In cases where the project is not within the core areas of Computer Science, the student should check with the examiner well in advance that the project is suitable and the project description must clearly explain the relevance for Computer Science.

Many project proposals concern applications of Computer Science. Such projects often have enough Computer Science content to make them suitable as degree projects, but it is important that the Computer Science content is highlighted and that issues related to the application area are not allowed to dominate. The scientific problem must be in the area of Computer Science and not in the application area.

It must be understood that software development is not a scientific problem, which is required by the syllabus. Thus software development projects are not suitable as degree projects. Software development is allowed insofar it supports the scientific study. E.g. a project about developing new algorithms may need software development to implement the algorithms for making validation and evaluation possible. That is acceptable, but as a rule of thumb such software development may not take up more than a third of the project time. If the software development itself is the subject of the study, e.g. if the project studies code quality obtained from different software development methods, then up to half of the time may be spent on software development. It is also required that:

- There are clearly defined and delimited goals of the project, outlining relevant scientific problems to be addressed.
- The chosen method(s) are connected to the literature. It is expected that the choice of the method(s) is justified based on the problem at hand and contextualised with respect to possible alternative choices.
- To perform a scientific validation of the presented approach to evaluate the extent to which it meets some clearly defined evaluation criteria. This may be in the form of empirical evaluation and/or theoretical validation (e.g., as mathematical proof). The evaluation method(s) should be suitable for the chosen criteria, and be motivated as such.
- To analyse and discuss in depth the key findings of the project, both positive and negative when applicable, in a manner that demonstrates understanding and knowledge of the subject matter.

A note from the Program Coordinator:

What is an acceptable degree thesis project? Read more about it [here](#).

Masters Programme in Computational Science, 120 credits (TBV2M)

The degree project must address a scientific question within the broad field of Computational Science. The project must clearly formulate the research question and use computational tools or methods to answer it. Suitable topics include, for example, numerical analysis, numerical methods for partial differential equations, scientific computing, bioinformatics, data science, data analysis, high-performance computing, and computing on modern architectures.

The project must have clearly defined and delimited scientific goals. The chosen computational methods must be motivated and connected to relevant literature, and the approach must be scientifically validated through theoretical analysis, numerical experiments, or performance evaluation. The results should be critically analysed and discussed, including limitations and possible directions for future work.

Pure implementation work is not sufficient; the project must address and contribute to a scientific problem. The final report must follow the university's guidelines and formal requirements.

Masters Programme in Embedded Systems, 120 credits (TIS2M)

The project must be clearly connected to the area of embedded systems. In cases where this is not obviously so, the report and the project description must convincingly explain the connection and relevance to embedded systems. It is also required that:

- There are clearly defined and delimited goals of the project, outlining relevant scientific and/or technical problems to be addressed.

- The project is put into a broader context based on the existing literature of related work, which is properly cited, with key differences and similarities of the related work to the current project pointed out.
- The chosen method(s) are connected to the literature. It is expected that the choice of the method(s) is justified based on the problem at hand and contextualised with respect to possible alternative choices.
- The presented approach is evaluated by following a proper scientific approach. It is assessed to which extent the presented approach meets some clearly defined evaluation criteria. This may be in the form of empirical evaluation and/or theoretical validation (e.g., as mathematical proof). The evaluation method(s) should be suitable for the chosen criteria, and be motivated as such.
- The key findings of the project are analysed and discussed in depth, both positive and negative findings when applicable, in a manner that demonstrates understanding and knowledge of the subject matter.
- Relevant future work and open problems remaining after the project are identified.
- In particular, note that pure implementation work is not considered sufficient for a degree project. Projects that include a significant implementation part must still meet the requirements listed above.
- The report must follow the university guidelines. Please notice that a report not following this style will be returned to the student without additional feedback, which may significantly delay the thesis revision and examination process.

A note from the Program Coordinator:

Please note that the entry requirement have been updated for the degree project and the following must be fulfilled for the **30/45 credit project**

“One out of two options: (Option 1): two out of three of the courses Programming of Embedded Systems, Wireless Communication and Networked Embedded Systems and Model-based Development of Embedded Software or (Option 2): one of: IT, Sustainability and Social Responsibility or IT, Ethics and Organisation. Participation in Introduction to Studies in Embedded Systems.”

For the **15 credit project**, Option 1 becomes ‘one out of three’ rather than ‘two out of three’, the remaining parts are the same.

Lastly, when submitting the initial proposal for the project, the student is expected to include a separate section with the details of how the bulleted requirement list will be met.

We are grateful to an anonymous student for allowing their work to be used as **an example** as given below:

The project must be clearly connected to the area of embedded systems. In cases where this is not obviously so, the report and the project description must convincingly explain the connection and relevance to embedded systems.

The project focuses on component-level testing of XYZ’s Radio Control System, which involves both software and hardware modules such as bootloaders and communication interfaces. These components are embedded within a larger system architecture and are

tested on emulators and dedicated ASIC hardware, establishing a clear connection to embedded systems.

The project is put into a broader context based on the existing literature of related work, which is properly cited, with key differences and similarities of the related work to the current project pointed out.

The proposal will explore and evaluate existing test protocols and tools for embedded components. In the thesis, this will be expanded by citing related literature and pointing out how the proposed framework compares with other existing solutions in scope, tooling, or methodology.

The chosen method(s) are connected to the literature. It is expected that the choice of the method(s) is justified based on the problem at hand and contextualised with respect to possible alternative choices.

The use of a YAML-driven testing framework and automation scripts in Python and Shell is justified through both industry standards and research in test automation. The chosen methods are connected to established practices in embedded-system test orchestration and are selected for their adaptability across emulated and hardware environments.

The presented approach is evaluated by following a proper scientific approach. It is assessed to which extent the presented approach meets some clearly defined evaluation criteria. This may be in the form of empirical evaluation and/or theoretical validation (e.g., as mathematical proof). The evaluation method(s) should be suitable for the chosen criteria, and be motivated as such.

The proposal's goal is to evaluate reliability, performance, and coverage of the components using automated methods. A proper evaluation framework will be designed to measure these aspects quantitatively, using both the SVP emulator and, if possible, ASIC hardware as testbeds.

The key findings of the project are analysed and discussed in depth, both positive and negative findings when applicable, in a manner that demonstrates understanding and knowledge of the subject matter.

The results will be analysed to assess improvements in scalability, coverage, and efficiency while discussing limitations such as emulator accuracy and hardware accessibility. Both successful outcomes and challenges will be interpreted in the broader context of embedded-system testing, demonstrating deep understanding.

Relevant future work and open problems remaining after the project are identified.

The thesis will outline possible extensions such as integration testing, CI/CD pipeline automation, and advanced test analytics. Open problems including hardware abstraction and test stability will be identified for future research.

In particular, note that pure implementation work is not considered sufficient for a degree project. Projects that include a significant implementation part must still meet the requirements listed above.

While the project includes a strong implementation component, it is complemented by design, evaluation, and analysis of test methodologies. The work demonstrates understanding of both theoretical testing principles and practical engineering application. To meet this criterion, the student will ensure that proper analysis, comparison with alternatives, and critical evaluation are included in the final report.

Masters Programme in Data Science, 120 credits (TDA2M)

General requirements

The project must include:

- the development of new data science concepts and/or methods,
- and/or the application of existing data science methods to a problem.

It is also required that:

- The chosen method(s) are connected to the literature. For example, in an applied data science project it is expected that the choice of the method(s) is justified based on the problem at hand and contextualised with respect to possible alternative choices.
- To perform a scientific validation of the presented approach, e.g. regarding efficiency, performance, the extent to which it meets some clearly defined evaluation criteria.
- To perform a societal/ethical validation. In particular, it is mandatory to include a well-thought section of the report on ethical reflections and societal impact. If no ethical considerations/implications are relevant for the given project, this has to be explicitly mentioned.
- The report must follow the university guidelines. Please notice that a report not following this style will be returned to the student without additional feedback, which may significantly delay the thesis revision and examination process.

Questions & Answers

Q1: what counts as a data science problem/application area?

In case of an applied project, any application area is ok as long as it requires advanced data science methods.

Q2: what counts as an advanced data science method?

Any method that would fit one or more courses in the programme outline of any of the two specialisations, with the exception of the Bachelor-level bridging courses Database Design I and Linear Algebra for Data Science, shall be considered a good fit for the thesis project.

Q3: Must the topic of the thesis be clearly connected to a course in the programme?

No, it does not have to, as long as it concerns:

the use of computational methods to extract knowledge from large and/or complex data, and/or the theory of computational methods to extract knowledge from large and/or complex data.

Q4: What does “large and/or complex data” mean, by the way?

Any data that requires the application of advanced data science methods to solve the problem at hand. A database with 1000000 employee records is neither large nor complex if we want to list the names of the employees in alphabetical order, because we can solve this task with a simple SQL query. Learning a model to determine which employees should be fired based on the expected impact on the company's revenues would make this data complex, and maybe even large (depending on the used methods), although this might not pass the societal/ethical validation.

Q5: If I study one specialisation, should I focus on projects that are related to the courses in my specialisation?

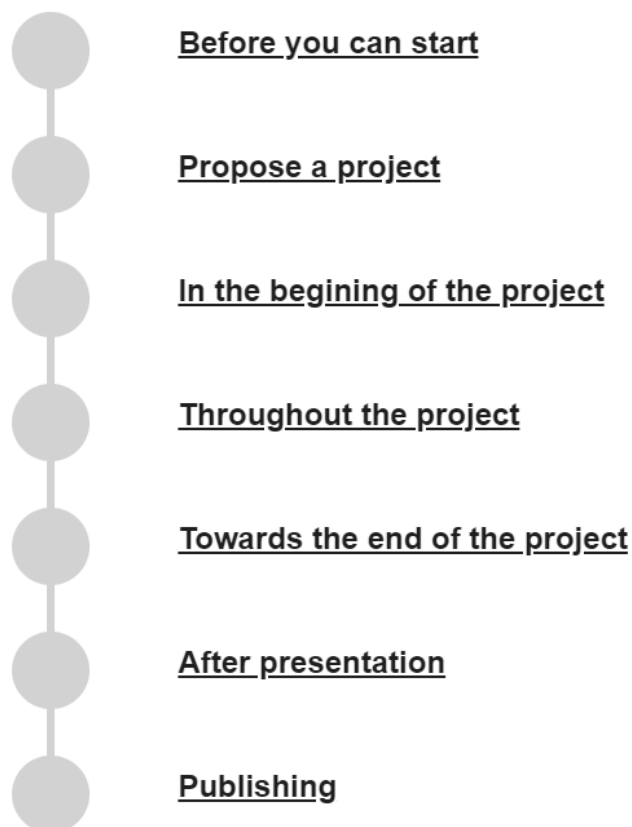
The degree is in data science, independently of your specialisation (which is “just” a way to help students choose a homogeneous set of courses leading to advanced topics in the specialisation area). So a student registered to one specialisation can do a thesis that is related to courses listed in the outline of the other specialisation, as long as the student has (or can acquire as part of the thesis) the needed competencies and skills.

Masters Program in Computer and Information Engineering, 300 credits (TIT2Y)

More information can be found [here](#). Contact the course examiner if you are experiencing difficulties accessing the link.

Thesis process

The process consists of the following steps as detailed below and summarised [here](#).



Before you can start

Before you start the thesis course, it is important to attend the information meeting to understand the process thoroughly and address any questions you may have. In addition, you have to apply to the thesis course.

Courses available

Students in the Master's Programme have to apply for the thesis course via University Admission or Antagning. The credit requirements for each thesis course can be found in the course plan. The courses on offer are:

TBA2M

- 1MD038 Degree Project E in Image Analysis and Machine Learning, 30 credits

TDV2M

- 1DT440 Degree Project D in Computer Science, 15 credits
- 1DT540 Degree Project E in Computer Science, 30 credits
- 1DT550 Degree Project E in Computer Science, 45 credits (starts in period 2)

Please note that for 1TD550, the following are prerequisites:

- Both student and supervisor must reach an agreement to develop a project plan for 45 credits.
- Along with the project plan, the student must submit a letter of motivation explaining why this project necessitates 45 credits (an additional 15 credits) with the supervisor's signature to the program coordinator.
- Your subject reviewer must agree that this project requires the additional time (15 credits).
- Subsequently, the students are required to send the program coordinator the project plan, motivation letter, and consent from the subject reviewer.

TBV2M

- 1TD908 Degree Project D in Computational Science, 15 credits
- 1TD808 Degree Project E in Computational Science, 30 credits
- 1TD708 Degree Project E in Computational Science, 45 credits (starts in period 2)

Please note that for 1TD708, the following are prerequisites:

- Both student and supervisor must reach an agreement to develop a project plan for 45 credits.
- Along with the project plan, the student must submit a letter of motivation explaining why this project necessitates 45 credits (an additional 15 credits) with the supervisor's signature to the program coordinator.
- Your subject reviewer must agree that this project requires the additional time (15 credits).
- Subsequently, the students are required to send the program coordinator the project plan, motivation letter, and consent from the subject reviewer.

TIS2M

- 1DT087 Degree Project D in Embedded Systems, 15 credits
- 1DT068 Degree Project E in Embedded Systems, 30 credits
- 1DT090 Degree Project E in Embedded Systems, 45 credits (starts in period 2)

Please note that for 1DT090, the following are prerequisites:

- Both student and supervisor must reach an agreement to develop a project plan for 45 credits.
- Along with the project plan, the student must submit a letter of motivation explaining why this project necessitates 45 credits (an additional 15 credits) with the supervisor's signature to the program coordinator.
- If approved by the program coordinator, then the student can register for the course.

TDA2M

- 1DL390 Degree Project D in Data Science, 15 credits
- 1DL510 Degree Project E in Data Science, 30 credits

TIT2Y

- 1DT960 Degree Project in Computer and Information Engineering, 30 credits

Once you apply to a thesis course, you will receive a confirmation email of your request. Please check your spam folder if you haven't received the email. After the deadline, we will check your eligibility for the course. If accepted, the admission results will be published on University Admission or Antagning.

Questions about the required credits should be directed to the [student counsellors](#) for your programs as they deal with queries about course selection, programmes, and different branches within programmes. If you have issues related to your studies, the student counsellors are who you turn to.

Propose a project

Find a thesis project internally at the IT Department or externally at a company or organisation. The purpose of the degree project must align with the objectives of the program and its guidelines as outlined in the syllabus and by the examiners.

Submit a project plan (that has been approved by your supervisor) of the thesis in HotCRP according to the instructions of the thesis coordinator before the specified deadline. Specify the start and end date of the project corresponding to the start and end date of study periods.

A student can find a thesis project internally at the IT Department or externally at a company or organisation, in Sweden or outside of Sweden.

Finding a project

Internally

The Department of Information Technology conducts research in the following research areas: image analysis, computer systems, optimisation, computing education research, parallel and distributed systems, control and dynamical systems, programming languages and systems, cybersecurity, semantics and verifications, data science, software engineering, embedded and real-time systems, artificial intelligence, human-machine interaction, and computational science. You can read more about it on the department's website [here](#). If you are interested in an advertised thesis project at the IT department at the university, please get in touch with the contact person by email, phone, or in person.

Remember that being proactive and prepared are key to being selected. Proactivity means taking initiative and anticipating what needs to be done before it's even asked of you. Don't wait for instructions; instead, actively seek ways to contribute and make a difference. Be ready to dive in with enthusiasm, knowledge and skills relevant to the project's objectives. Furthermore, think deeply about how you are a good fit for the project. Consider your unique strengths, experiences, and passions that align with the project's goals. Demonstrating your genuine interest and how you can add value will increase your chances.

Externally

If you are interested in a thesis project in another department, another university, or a company, make sure you have a CV and cover letter ready for submitting a project plan.

Uppsala University career support offers a number of services, including feedback on employment letters, help with writing a CV and cover letter and career counselling. You can book an appointment with them on their website.

It is the responsibility of the student to find a suitable thesis project. Please start applying for projects early as responses from a supervisor/handledare at a company or university may take some time.

Please note that not all external projects are suitable for Masters thesis projects. First and foremost, projects should be relevant to the degree course the student is a part of. Projects primarily involving implementation (program design/coding/testing/debugging) work are not generally acceptable (although sometimes an implementation project can be made acceptable by including suitable design issues).

As a rule of thumb, not more than a third of the project should be implementation work. If the implementation presents particular challenges which are connected to the subject of the thesis project, then up to half the effort may be implementation. Also, projects where the student is continually working from instructions are also generally not acceptable as the student should carry out independent work. To prevent this, it is advisable to find a thesis project at the university or at a company that has experience providing thesis projects for students.

Submitting a project plan to HotCRP

Once you find a thesis project internally or externally, you need to submit a project plan approved and signed digitally by your supervisor to HotCRP to formally start your thesis project. You can use <https://edesign.sunet.se/> or other software to sign the document. No project plans will be accepted after the deadline.

The project plan must be in PDF format and contain the following sections. A template in [Word](#) and [Overleaf](#) is provided. Please leave the placeholder of the subject reviewer blank in order for the subject reviewer to fill it in.

If the project plan is accepted, you will be registered for the course in Ladok on the first week of the start of the period. Note that you cannot register for the thesis course yourself in Ladok. The responsible department will complete the registration no later than the first week of the relevant study period. You will also be assigned a subject reviewer by then or earlier.

The project plan should contain:

Title

The title is preliminary, i.e. the report can have another title. The title should not be longer than about 12 words.

Abstract

A brief summary or overview of your project plan. It provides the reader with a concise description of the project's main purpose, research questions, methods, and conclusions. Abstracts help readers quickly determine whether a particular project or research is relevant to their interests or research needs, without having to read the full proposal. A well-written abstract should be clear, concise, and informative, and it should accurately reflect the content of the full proposal.

Background

Here you describe in what context your thesis is to be done. What prerequisites are valid, what is the goal of the project from the supervisor's point of view, what is available and has been done before, under what circumstances should the work be done.

Description of the task

Here you describe in more detail the contents of the project: what should be done and what moments are included. Specifically it should be described the interesting part of the problem, how this should be analysed and solved. Here there should be clarified that the project fulfils the requirements that the university has posed on a thesis project on this level.

Methods

What systems, tools and methods should be used. Relevant literature (it is often a part of the work to find additional literature). How results should be evaluated and documented.

Relevant courses

A list of courses that are of particularly interest for the project.

Delimitations

It is also important to specify what is not part of the project. This prevents that the thesis grows uncontrolled. You can add stuff that you can do if there are time left, also write down things that can be skipped if there are not time for them.

Time plan

Here you find the time plan for the project. When to start and how much time has been allocated for each moment. (the fine grading can vary, but no blocks bigger than about 4 weeks should be listed). The time plan should take into consideration factors such as part time work, vacations, other obligations etc. Some moments, like writing, is usually done in parallel with other tasks. A graphical Gantt chart is encouraged. Regular meetings with your reviewer should be booked.

References

One or more relevant references.

Hints

- Remember that your subject reviewer is going to read your proposal, write accordingly!
- Do not copy/paste the project advertisement, you can use some parts that makes the project plan interesting to the researchers in the area. This makes it more clear and concrete.
- Examples of previous project plans can be found [here](#). Don't forget to use the new templates provided for the project plan.
- Examples of previous theses at the IT Department can be found on DiVA. You can also contact the examiners for exemplary thesis reports.
- Write down what is considered to be the core of the thesis, and what has potential to be the base in the analysis part of the report.
- Find out what research subject (or what course) that are closest to the project. Write the specification with that in mind.
- We strongly require you to avoid confidentiality agreements with companies and confidential reports. If necessary, use the official university collaboration form which can be found [here](#) (don't ask for permission, download it). The confidentiality agreement is to be handed in to HotCRP ahead of the project. The Thesis Coordinator will sign it after the student gets the signature from the supervisor before communicating any sensitive material. Please make sure that the agreement has been accepted by the Thesis Coordinator at the start of the project. If you haven't received a confirmation, please contact the Coordinator.
- If you have any questions about research ethics please contact Mikael Laaksoharju.

In the beginning of the project

Once you are assigned a subject reviewer contact them immediately by email. Be prepared and review the project plan following the instructions of the reviewer, in collaboration with the supervisor. The revised project plan should be signed by the reviewer, the supervisor, and the student. Update the signatures and upload the updated documents in HotCRP as a comment within two weeks of the start of the course.

Agree on a schedule for when to meet with the reviewer throughout the course.

It is recommended to meet with the reviewer at 25%, 50% and 75% of the thesis work.

In some instances, group reviewing may be used. In that case, a group of students will meet with the reviewer every time.

Agree on means of communication with the reviewer between scheduled meetings (for example, email, slack, phone...).

Throughout the project

Attend scheduled meetings with the reviewer.

Submit written parts of the thesis so far before each meeting corresponding to your progress (instructions will be provided by the reviewer). If reviewing is done in groups, give feedback on other students' work.

Keep the subject reviewer informed on how the project progresses. Revise the time plan if needed.

Together with the reviewer, plan a final presentation date as early as possible.

Advice on writing

- The written report is very important. Consider that your report will be used as a personal merit and will be evaluated based on the metrics [here](#).
- Start the writing process early. Don't leave it till the end, but do it continuously. It takes 1-2 months to write a good report.
- Remember that good language is important. The quality of the language is a learning outcome in the course so your report could be rejected due to bad language. Use the resources available at the university including the language workshop, library services, and additional online tools such as Grammarly.
- The use of ChatGPT and other Large Language Model (LLM) Applications to write your report is left to the discretion of the examiner. Consult them first before you use them.
- There are no rules about the size of a report, but a report shorter than 30 pages is probably incomplete. A report of 80 pages or more probably contains too much code or similar. In other words, a normal report is around 40 pages. Consult your examiner if you have further questions.
- For LaTeX templates, you can use the template provided by Tobias Wrigstad, Head of Education, [here](#).
- [Here](#) is a document that contains advice for a Masters thesis report.
- [Here](#) is a fantastic template provided by the student Oskar Perers (thank you!).

Towards the end of the project

Submit a draft version of the thesis to the reviewer (normally two-three weeks) before the planned presentation date.

Ask the subject reviewer to book time for the final presentation. Booking a presentation time is not allowed until the reviewer has approved it based on the draft thesis. The subject reviewer should send an email (with the student copied) to exjobb@it.uu.se to request a presentation slot advertised on the thesis website. The email should include the following information: student's personnummer, first and last name, the course code for the thesis course and the title. Additionally, in the email, the subject reviewer should confirm that the report is ready for presentation. The presentation slots available are released by the examiner. If you would like to request additional slots, contact the examiner directly. An opponent will be assigned to you as well once a presentation is booked. A reviewer is required to attend. The supervisor is invited to attend, but their presence is not required.

Send a close to finished version of the thesis to the assigned opponent and the examiner no later than a week before the scheduled presentation.

Prepare and perform a project presentation according to the instructions you will be receiving, a reminder that the evaluation criteria can be found [here](#). A copy of the responsibilities of the opposition can be found [here](#).

Prepare and perform opposition to another student's thesis. Instructions on who will be your opponent will be sent to you by email once you book your presentation.

After presentation

Agree with the reviewer on a deadline for sending your final version of the report.

Prepare the final version of the report based on feedback given during the presentation.

Send the final version of the report to the reviewer for final approval.

Publishing

When you've passed your degree project you should publish the written report to DiVA.

First you need to create a serial number for the front page.

Then you can upload the final version of the report to DiVA (see the instructions in the email reply you receive when creating a serial number)

If the degree project needs secrecy or a delayed time for publishing the report shall be archived but not published in DiVA.

Frequently asked questions

Q. I have a question about the number of credits required for a thesis course, registration, or the eligibility for some credits?

Please contact the [student counsellors](#) of your programs.

Q. I am an exchange student, can I register for a thesis course at Uppsala University?

If you are an exchange student, please contact the [student counsellors](#) first to check your eligibility to apply to the thesis course.

Q. I have a question about the use of GenAI for my thesis?

The university has strict guidelines about the use of GenAI for thesis projects. You can read about them here in [English](#) or here in [Swedish](#).

Q. Can I take another course while I'm enrolled in the thesis course?

It is generally not advisable to take courses while doing a thesis course for several reasons:

- **Time Constraints:** a thesis project requires a significant amount of time and effort. Trying to juggle coursework with a thesis can lead to time management issues, resulting in both coursework and the thesis being of lower quality due to a lack of time and attention.
- **Distraction:** taking courses can distract from the focus and concentration required for the thesis project. It can be challenging to switch between different subject matters and maintain a high level of motivation and focus.
- **Stress:** Completing a thesis project is a significant academic undertaking that can be stressful and demanding. Adding coursework to the mix can increase the pressure and lead to burnout and mental exhaustion.
- **Overall,** while it may be possible to balance coursework and a thesis project, it is generally better to focus on the thesis project to ensure the best possible outcome.

Q. Can I suggest my own idea for a thesis project?

Some students want to work on a thesis based on their own ideas, maybe because they want to test some ideas. We strongly discourage you from trying this. The reasons for this are twofold; it will be very difficult to find a supervisor for this. Supervision is a task that doesn't generate any economical reward. Therefore supervisors are usually only interested in projects formulated by themselves. In addition, these projects are often loosely defined and tend to be late.

Q. Can I contact a subject reviewer?

It is the responsibility of the thesis coordinator to assign a subject reviewer to students as the thesis coordinator is well informed about the subject reviewer research area, expertise, and availability for reviewing responsibilities. Therefore it is prohibited for students to contact Subject Reviewers.

Q. Can I work on a project with another student from the same department?

The degree project is an independent project. Only a few Masters degree Programs allow the collaboration of several students. Please check with the examiner of the Masters thesis course.

If several students are collaborating on a thesis project, each student is required to do an individual oral presentation of the project, clearly specifying their individual contributions. Each student's contributions shall also be presented in the written reports/the written report.

Q. I'm not sure about the suitability of the thesis project?

Read the course syllabus on the university website and the information regarding the requirements of a thesis project in this document to assist you.

Q. Can I apply for a thesis project outside of Sweden?

You can pursue a thesis project outside of Sweden as long as it adheres to The Higher Education Ordinance (1993:100) issued by the Swedish Council for Higher Education, and the learning outcomes as outlined in the syllabus of the Master Thesis Course.

Q. When are internal projects list released?

The internal project list is regularly updated based on the availability of projects from university supervisors. It is your responsibility to frequently check for the latest postings. If a project listed is already assigned, please contact the thesis coordinator for further investigation. This could either mean the project requires more than one student or the supervisor has not yet removed it after it was filled.

Q. What happens if I can't find a project in time?

It is the responsibility of each student to find a suitable task for their degree project. If a student fails to find a relevant degree project, then the reasons behind the delay will be investigated with the examiner and consequently, several scenarios could happen including but not limited to:

- The examiner may assist with finding a degree project; or
- The student may be assigned a reviewer after securing a project whose expertise do not fully align with the project's scope; or
- The secured project is rejected and the student is asked to apply again at the next instance of the course.

Q. My external project might require resources (for example UPPMAX) who should I contact?

It is the responsibility of the company or organisation to arrange sufficient resources for the completion of the project. As such, please consider the availability of these resources at the company or organisation before you start the thesis project.

Q. I have questions about experiments and the ethical implications in my project?

Contact the ethics officer at the IT Department Mikael Laaksoharju.

Q. I might be working on a project that deals with confidential information. What should I do?

The basic rule is that degree projects shall not be subject to confidentiality.

Companies, government agencies and other organisations, may in some cases need to classify degree projects as confidential, supported by the law of confidentiality. It is important to decide if it is the report that is confidential, or information that is shared during the process, for example because the student is present at the company. All involved must be provided with clear information and a special confidentiality agreement, the Uppsala University form, signed before the project begins.

Ultimately it is the student that must decide on what confidentiality obligations are acceptable to them and the university will merely advise on these matters, though it must be regarded as in the interest of both the student and the university that the student is not obligated to get an approval of the company to submit information to the university. This since an absence of such approval could risk the possibility to submit the final report for examination. The recommendation of the Legal Affairs Division is consequently that the student always reserves the right to submit information to the university to the extent necessary to be able to complete their studies.

Q. What happens if there are parts of my thesis report that I cannot publish?

The University is a governmental authority, therefore we are obliged to adhere to the principle of public access to official records. What can be classified as confidential is controlled by the secrecy act and it is important that all such matters are clarified in advance. Only external thesis projects can be confidential and we require that an agreement of confidentiality is signed before starting the thesis when required. It is recommended to use the official university [form](#) titled "UU Template Collaboration agreement for degree projects at Uppsala University in collaboration with a third party".

Note that we strongly recommend you to avoid confidential reports if you can. You cannot use such a report as a merit and it will not be published in any way.

A solution to the problem of confidential reports can be to extract confidential parts from the report that is sent to the university, e.g. to have these parts in a separate appendix, this can be test data or other detailed information. However, the report sent to the university must still fulfil our requirements of content and depth in these cases.

Q. What should I do if my supervisor/reviewer is not responding to me?

At the beginning of the thesis project, it is essential that you, your supervisor, and your subject reviewer agree on clear communication channels (for example, email or Slack) and the expected frequency of contact. It is also important to be aware of each other's schedules, such as planned conference travel, teaching duties, or other commitments, as this will help set realistic expectations for response times. Likewise, you should communicate your own availability and any periods when you may be unable to respond promptly.

Please keep in mind that supervisors and reviewers may not be able to reply immediately; for example, receiving an email response the following day is not always realistic. However,

if you have contacted your supervisor or reviewer and have not received a reply within a reasonable timeframe, and you know they are not away or otherwise occupied, you should first send a polite reminder. Occasionally, emails are missed or overlooked, and a gentle follow-up helps ensure nothing falls through the cracks.

If you still do not receive a response after a reminder, you may send another message and include the Thesis Coordinator exjobb@it.uu.se in the Cc field so that the situation can be addressed appropriately.

Q. What should I answer if my supervisor asked about their expectations within the role?

The supervisor is the person most in contact with the student during the work. It is primarily the supervisor who supports and encourages the student to work independently and complete the task in accordance with the established plan. It is important that the supervisor has a solid level of competence and is readily available for the student for the duration of the degree project.

The supervisor of a degree project:

1. establishes, in collaboration with the student, a preliminary project plan for the implementation of the degree project and signs the application form for the degree project before the student registers for the course.
2. updates the project plan together with the student and the subject reader no later than five weeks after project initiation.
3. is responsible for organizing and implementing appropriate and ongoing supervision, supporting the student's work progress and timetable.
4. holds a position at the workplace where the degree project is carried out and is competent in the particular area.
5. ensures that the student is familiarised with the organization, documentation requirements, necessary routines, and security aspects that apply to the workplace.
6. supports and encourages the student to strive for independence and responsibility in various aspects of the pursuit of knowledge.
7. contacts the subject reader should problems arise.
8. supports the student in writing the report and provides continuous feedback on content as well as language and structure. Should the student have problems with the written expression, the supervisor may recommend the student to seek tutoring at Språkverkstaden (at UU). If so, the supervisor should also inform the subject reader.
9. is invited to attend the student's presentation of the degree project.
10. consult the examiner if the project is not completed after eleven months of full-time study for a degree project of 45 higher education credits, seven months for a degree project 30 of higher education credits, or four months for a degree project of 15 higher education credits.

Q. Can I get access to working space at the university whilst working on the thesis?

If you are conducting internal research as part of the thesis course at the university, a working space is allocated to you on the first week of the start of your thesis. You will receive a notification once this step has been completed.

Q. Who should I contact if there is a problem?

The subject reviewer should be contacted in the following cases. Include the thesis coordinator in the Cc field:

- Pause or termination of the project.
- Deviation from the time plan in the specification.
- Change of Supervisor.
- The student takes on work that can affect the time plan.
- Other changes of the specification or deviations from it.
- The student is offered employment by the company.
- The student experience lack of support from the supervisor or in the working environment.
- Other circumstances that can be expected to lead to difficulties in supervision (like reorganisations or illness of the supervisor).
- Conflict between the Supervisor and the student.

Q. What should I do if there are delays due to illness?

Delays due to illness could be accommodated if reasonably feasible. Remember to promptly notify your Supervisor and Subject Reviewer about the delays and propose a new action plan. You should also contact the Student Health Services here for support. If necessary, report your illness to Försäkringskassan for documentation purposes. For students receiving CSN grants, CSN takes duly reported illness (sjukskrivningar) into account. Read more about it on CSN website.

Q. Who should I contact if I need additional support due to a disability?

If you have a long-term disability that affects your studies, you can get targeted study support during your time at Uppsala University. The support offered is based on your individual needs and aims to facilitate your studies. The goal is for all students to have an opportunity to study on equal terms. Their contact details can be found on the university website.

Q. Can I enrol in a 15 credits degree project?

The university provides a "magister" degree, primarily for historical reasons. This qualification is attainable after one year of study in a master's program. It's distinct from a

traditional master's degree but serves as an alternative completion option for students unable to finish the two-year master's program for various reasons.

Q. What do I need to do if I want to extend my student account?

If you are in the process of completing a thesis project and would like to extend your student account, please contact exjobb@it.uu.se with an extension request containing the following:

- Email title "Thesis Student Account Extension Request".
- Reason behind the extension.
- Expiration date of the account (contact IT Support if you are uncertain).
- Period of extension.
- Confirmation from the subject reviewer that the requested extension period is reasonable and you will complete your thesis on time after being granted the extension. If you cannot get the approval of the Subject Reviewer please state the reason in the email.

Q. What do I need to do if I need to extend a thesis project?

While it may seem tempting to extend your thesis project in order to delve deeper into your research, there are a number of reasons why this may not be the best course of action. Firstly, extending your project may result in you running out of time to complete it to the standard required for your degree. In addition, your Supervisor or Subject Reviewer might not be available for additional support during the extension period. Finally, the longer you spend working on your project, the more difficult it may become to maintain motivation and focus, which could impact the quality of your work. Therefore, it's important to carefully consider whether extending your thesis project is truly necessary and to consult with your supervisor and subject Reviewer before making any decisions.

Students who will not finish their project within the far exceeded time-frame (not completed within eleven months of full-time study in Degree Project, 45 higher education credits; seven months full-time study in Degree Project, 30 higher education credits; or four months full-time study in Degree Project, 15 higher education credits) are required to submit a thesis extension [form](#) (the name of the file should be surname_firstname.pdf). If you still want to go ahead with the request, please contact exjobb@it.uu.se with an extension request, containing the following:

- Email title "Thesis Student Project Extension Request".
- Reason behind the extension.
- Period of extension.
- Confirmation from the Supervisor and Subject Reviewer that the requested extension period is reasonable and you will complete your thesis on time after being granted the extension. Include both of them in the Cc field. If you cannot get the approval of one or both of them please state the reason in the email.

Extension requests will be examined on a case-by-case basis. A decision will be communicated to the student soon after.

Q. What happens if the degree project is not approved or finished on time?

If a degree project receives a failing grade, a written statement must be provided, usually with suggestions of further actions to be taken by the student in order to be approved. In case of a failing degree project, the student may request a second assessment by other grading course teachers.

If a degree project has far exceeded the planned time-frame (not completed within eleven months of full-time study in Degree Project, 45 higher education credits; seven months full-time study in Degree Project, 30 higher education credits; or four months full-time study in Degree Project, 15 higher education credits), or should conflicts arise, the examiner shall contact the student/subject reader/supervisor and propose actions.

If the degree project is not completed within eighteen months (45 ECTS), twelve months (30 ECTS) or 9 months (15 ECTS), the student must re-register for the course in order to continue the degree project. New timetable and project plan shall be established, and a supervisor and subject reader appointed anew (may be the same as before).

Q. Does the university cover accident insurance and liability insurance during my thesis work externally?

You are covered by an insurance policy (FAS+) through the university, with Kammarkollegiet. This insurance is valid in Sweden for the duration of your studies, including when you are conducting your thesis project at an external company. The FAS+ insurance includes:

- Accident cover and emergency transportation home
- Emergency healthcare and emergency dental care (please note that compensation for emergency dental care is limited to a maximum of SEK 4,000 per calendar year)
- Liability cover, including claims for damages against you as a private individual, as a student or intern, or as a tenant
- Repatriation and legal cover
- Some property protection

You can find full details, including specific terms, exceptions, and limitations, in the official policy document here:

[Terms and Conditions – FAS+ 2025 \(Kammarkollegiet\).](#)

Q. Is there a tool for plagiarism detection?

Yes there is a tool called Inspira Originality (IO) intended for instructors' use. Instructors can read about it [here](#).

Q. Who do I need to contact if I discontinue my project?

If you need to take a break during your studies, you must [apply](#) for an academic leave of absence to have a guaranteed place on the programme after the break. If you make an unannounced interruption of studies, you have no guaranteed place to resume your studies.

Q. What do I need to do if I am a returning student who would like to continue the course?

If you are a returning thesis student who has not taken an official leave of absence from the thesis course, you are required to reach out to the examiner to reregister for the course. Please see the flow chart [here](#).

In the email, you should provide your name, personnummer, program of study, period the thesis course started, examiner name, reviewer name, progress status and reasons for leaving. Subsequently, the examiner will determine whether you should re-register for the course and whether you should continue with the same project or start a new one.

Q. How do I obtain my degree?

The Masters thesis is usually the last course of your education. As such when all of your courses are completed, you should apply for a degree certificate in Ladok. The date of your degree will be the one when your degree is issued at the Graduation Office. More information can be found [here](#).

Q. How do I submit a final report that contains confidential information in DiVA?

The Library's website provides answers to the most frequently asked questions about registering and publishing in DiVA. You can read more about it [here](#). If you can't find answers to your questions, contact the library as instructed on the website.

Q. How do I register for the graduation ceremony?

At the end of each academic year, there is a closing ceremony for students completing their studies. You can read more about the graduation ceremony and registration [here](#).

Q. How do I extend my residence permit?

For general questions regarding the Swedish Migration Agency, residence permits and visas, please email: studypermits@uu.se. If you require a visa extension letter, please find below instructions:

1. Students enrolled in the thesis course are expected to start and complete their studies within the scheduled timeframe.
2. Should a student fail to complete their thesis on time and need a visa extension letter, the subject reviewer will provide a letter detailing the student's progress, reasons for any delays,

and the anticipated completion date. This will include information about the presentation and revisions of the final report.

3. If the reviewer is unable to sign the letter, they can draft the content of the letter to be signed by the examiner.

The template can be found [here](#), for further assistance, please contact the [student counsellors](#).

Q. How do I stay in touch with the university after graduation?

You can join Uppsala University alumni network. The Uppsala University alumni network is a global network for all former students and staff members of Uppsala University. The network offers you a way to keep in touch with the University and former classmates, as well as opportunities to meet new friends and give back to your alma mater. To date, over 30,000 alumni in more than 150 countries around the world have chosen to become members. More information can be found on the university website.